

A Model of Spiritual Formation for Individuals and Small Groups

John Tittle | DSMN 850 | March 13, 2026

Compressed Reference Edition

Bridge: How This Paper Relates to the Other Formation Documents

This paper was originally written as a standalone treatment of the Affective Taxonomy applied to spiritual formation (DSMN 850, March 2026). Within the Intentional Journey of the Heart corpus, it sits alongside four companion papers. The Theological Anthropology paper (TA) provides the scriptural and philosophical account of the inner person on which this paper's use of Krathwohl's taxonomy rests. The Heart Formation Theology paper (HFT) develops the Affective Taxonomy specifically for heart formation, with trust in scripture as its worked example. The Soul and Spirit Taxonomies paper (SST) develops parallel five-stage maps for the soul and the spirit. The Formation Companion paper (FC) develops the person who facilitates this formation as a synthesis role. MSFIG is most directly in dialogue with HFT — which applies the Affective Taxonomy to the heart — and with FC, which describes the person who facilitates the small-group formation architecture MSFIG proposes. Read MSFIG together with HFT and FC for the fullest picture.

Abstract

This paper argues that the Affective Taxonomy of Krathwohl, Bloom, and Masia — describing how people progressively internalize values until those values become a stable, characteristic way of life — provides a defensible and scripturally coherent framework for describing the observable human side of spiritual formation. Grounded in the Parable of the Sower (Matt. 13:1–23; Mark 4:1–20), the taxonomy's five levels (Receiving, Responding, Valuing, Organization, Characterization) map to the progressive receptivity of the human heart to God's Word, with the 100-fold harvest representing Stage 5 Characterization. The framework is integrative (uniting individual and corporate formation), generative (reinterpreting preaching, worship, and suffering within a single model), and extensible (applicable across denominational and cultural contexts). The Holy Spirit remains the irreducible primary agent; the taxonomy describes the human side of that divine work, individually and collectively, in the fundamental spiritual discipline of hearing and obeying God.

1. Introductory Framing (Key Sources)

The paper navigates competing approaches to spiritual formation using David Powlison's three epistemic priorities: (1) establish what Scripture says; (2) understand the theory or discipline in depth, including its assumptions; (3) extract what aligns with scriptural truth and integrate appropriately ("Cure of Souls," 269–271). Four empirical/theoretical frameworks are evaluated against this grid:

Hawkins & Parkinson, *MOVE* (Zondervan, 2011): Empirical, multi-church study measuring growth using Jesus' two greatest commandments. Identifies four stages: Exploring Christ → Growing in Christ → Close to Christ → Christ-Centered. Most effective catalyst at all stages: reflective Bible study. Criticism (Asumang, *Conspectus* 14:1, 2012): self-report surveys, cross-sectional design, consumerist framework — adequate for identifying practices, inadequate for measuring internalization.

Christian Schwarz, *Natural Church Development* (ChurchSmart, 1996; 7th ed. 2006): Eight quality characteristics of healthy churches — empowering leadership, gift-oriented ministry, passionate spirituality, effective structures, inspiring worship, holistic small groups, need-oriented evangelism, loving relationships — with holistic small groups as the single quality most correlated with overall health across cultures. Organizing framework: the Trinitarian Compass, which maps all NCD tools onto the three classical transcendentals (Truth, Goodness, Beauty) corresponding to the three persons of the Trinity — the same coordinate axes as TFT. Diagnostic logic: the minimum-factor strategy (Liebig's Law applied to church health), identifying the rate-limiting quality characteristic as the first intervention target. The *Energy Trilogy* (2021–2022) deepens the theological foundation of the NCD framework by recovering the NT *energeia* vocabulary and grounding the energy paradigm in Paul's letters. Survey database: 70,000+ churches, 84 countries, 112 denominations. Criticism (Ellas & Yeakley, *JASCG* 10:2, 1999): methodological concerns and lack of analytic transparency; (9Marks): hermeneutical concerns about use of biotic metaphors as interpretive frameworks for Scripture.

Richard Foster, *Celebration of Discipline* (HarperSanFrancisco, 1998): Groups classic spiritual disciplines into inner, outer, and corporate — useful taxonomy of practices but does not address motivation or internalization progression.

Paul Bramer, "Christian Formation: Tweaking the Paradigm" (*CEJ*, Fall 2007): Identifies that Christian education over-emphasizes cognitive acquisition; proposes the Affective Taxonomy as the more appropriate framework for formation. This paper builds directly on Bramer's proposal.

2. Theological Background (Compressed Summaries)

2.1 Old Testament Theology of Spiritual Formation

Key argument (Averbeck, Lowe): OT spiritual formation is primarily corporate, focused on forming Israel as "a kingdom of priests and a holy nation" (Exod. 19:6) through covenantal obedience; the Holy Spirit is the primary agent, working through life-giving, empowering, cleansing (Ezek. 36:25–28), and heart-renewing functions that point forward to NT fulfillment. Key OT-to-NT bridge: Averbeck notes the combination of divine activities in Ezekiel 36 constitutes the regenerating and renewing of hearts that both testaments describe, with Jesus applying it directly to Nicodemus (John 3:5–15). Critical distinction (Lowe): OT anointing for leadership and prophecy (Saul, David, Eli) served collective formation, not individual spiritual development — gifting is not the same as personal formation. Brueggemann's orientation–disorientation–new orientation framework (Psalms) provides the pastoral template for redemptive suffering as a formation engine; John of the Cross's Dark Night of the Soul (Bk. 1, Ch. 6) applies the same dynamic at the individual level: staying in the desert of dryness enables a depth of trust unavailable to those who avoid it.

2.2 New Testament Theology of Spiritual Formation

Key argument (Bock, Thompson, Morrow): The NT continues and expands the Spirit's formation work, now extending individually to each believer at Pentecost while remaining fundamentally corporate in purpose — the Spirit empowers not primarily for miracles but for a righteous, God-honoring life lived in community (Titus 2:11–14). The church as a countercultural community of radical diversity (Lydia, the Roman jailer, the slave girl — Acts 16) becomes the visible witness: Thompson notes Paul assumes the gospel's transforming power will attract outsiders without direct evangelism commands (Paul, 170). The Parable of the Sower (Matt. 13:1–23) appears in this context: Jesus knew not everyone would receive his words, and his remark in Mark 4:13 — "How then will you understand all the parables?" — identifies hearing and obeying as the foundational, meta-discipline of spiritual formation. Suffering as formation: Peter (1 Pet. 1:6–7), James (1:2–4), and Paul (Rom. 8:28) all treat disorientation (Brueggemann) as a formation mechanism, not an interruption.

2.3 Pauline Theology of Spiritual Formation

Key argument (Lowe & Lowe, Thompson): Paul's theology is irreducibly corporate — the individual believer apart from the community is inconceivable to Paul (Thompson, Paul, 56). Formation occurs through a "syn-" ecology of interdependence (Lowe & Lowe, Ecologies, 50–63), with gifting distributed across the body for collective edification, not individual distinction (Eph. 4:1–16; 1 Cor 12–14). Individual dimensions: Lowe & Lowe identify six developmental dimensions (physical, intellectual, emotional, social, moral, spiritual), visualized as a palm with spiritual formation as the integrating center; 1 Timothy 3 addresses the same six dimensions for

leadership selection. Central formation challenge (Nee, *The Spiritual Man*, 29–32): the war between the human spirit (in contact with the Holy Spirit) and the body (in contact with the world) — whether we listen to God's voice or the world's is the perpetual struggle. Watchman Nee (*Normal Christian Church Life*, 115): denominational division fractures the local-universal church unity Paul assumed; the local church is all believers in a locality.

2.4 Thinking Theologically / Ecology of Spiritual Formation

Key argument (Lowe & Lowe, *Ecologies*): Jesus and Paul used nature parables because God works the same way to bring natural growth as he does spiritual growth — creation itself is God speaking (Rom. 1:19–21). Hearing and obeying is the foundational discipline: Deut. 28:1–68 ties all blessings and curses to hearkening; Jesus in John 15:3–17 grounds abiding in his love in keeping his commandments; Willard (*Hearing God*, 195) states the Word "enters the heart and from there is able to progressively transform the whole personality." The three levels of good soil (30-, 60-, 100-fold) point to progressive depths of internalization — Brueggemann's disorientation/suffering can act as fertilizer enabling movement from 30-fold toward 100-fold. MOVE and NCD empirical models: practices and identified stages are valuable, but both rely on single-point self-report surveys that can only capture Stage 1–2 behaviors, not the motivation and internalization of Stages 3–5.

3. The Central Argument: Affective Taxonomy Applied to Spiritual Formation

3.1 Theoretical Foundation

Source: Krathwohl, Bloom & Masia, *Taxonomy of Educational Objectives: Affective Domain* (David McKay, 1964), pp. 165–185.

Core claim (Bramer): Christian education has over-focused on cognitive acquisition; spiritual formation requires the affective domain — the progressive internalization of values.

Biblical grounding: The Parable of the Sower (Matt. 13:1–23) is the primary scriptural test of the taxonomy. Jesus' interpretive key in Mark 4:13 ("How then will you understand all the parables?") makes hearing and obeying a meta-discipline — the foundation for all spiritual discernment and all other disciplines.

Theological grounding: The taxonomy describes the human side of a Trinitarian work (Averbeck). The Holy Spirit is the primary agent; the taxonomy is descriptive, not prescriptive. Sudden and permanent changes of heart (sovereign Spirit work) can occur at any level. The taxonomy is humble about what it can measure: "The LORD sees, not as man sees" (1 Sam. 16:7).

Epistemic method: Powlison's three-step grid — (1) Scripture establishes the framework (Sower parable), (2) the secular taxonomy is examined on its own terms, (3) what aligns with scriptural truth is extracted and integrated.

3.2 Individual & Small Group Taxonomy (Combined Reference Table)

Level	Individual Taxonomy (Hearing & Obeying God)	Small Group Taxonomy (Collective Hearing & Obeying)
Stage 1 — Receiving	Aware of and willing to attend to God's word. Has heard the gospel, is exposed to Scripture, willing to listen. Floor of spiritual engagement. Sower parallel: seed on the path — word sown but not yet received.	Hearing God is mediated by the leader. Leader teaches; members listen. Prayer requests are informational rather than discernment-oriented.
Stage 2 — Responding	Actively engages, participates, complies, follows through. Joins Bible study, completes assigned readings, prays when prompted. Motivation is largely external: social expectation, accountability structures, curriculum requirements. Sower parallel: rocky soil — initial response, shallow roots.	Group begins processing together. Members build on each other's contributions. "Each one has a hymn, a lesson, a revelation" (1 Cor. 14:26). Leader asks genuine questions rather than curriculum questions. The Spirit distributes; group learns to receive from multiple sources.
Stage 3 — Valuing	Has internalized the value of hearing God — pursues it without external prompting. Reads Scripture not because a guide requires it but from personal desire. Serves from conviction rather than obligation. Critical shift: extrinsic → intrinsic motivation. Sower parallel: thorny soil — real growth, but distractions still compete.	Trust enables the group to move from discussing God's Word to discerning God's voice together. Members bring real decisions for genuine input. Corporate listening prayer becomes regular: group prays on a specific question, shares what they receive, notes convergences, explores divergences.
Stage 4 — Organizing	Integrates hearing from God into a coherent value system, resolving conflicts between competing values. Faith now informs vocation, relationships, finances, and daily decisions systemically. Sower parallel: good soil beginning to yield 30-fold and 60-fold harvest.	The group develops an integrated practice of corporate hearing and obeying. Individual hearing naturally submitted to group for testing; group's collective discernment informs individual decisions. Group hears God about itself — its health, blind spots, and calling. Obedience becomes corporate: group acts as a whole.

Stage 5 — Characterization

Hearing and obeying God has controlled behavior long enough to become a characteristic lifestyle and total worldview (Krathwohl: "integrated into a total philosophy or worldview"). The person does not deliberate about whether to act; it is who they are. 100-fold harvest; the mind of Christ. Pharisee counter-example: perfect Stage 2 compliance mistaken for Stage 5 transformation (Matt. 23:25; 21:31).

Former members lead new groups exhibiting the same culture — not by following a manual, but by having been formed by the original group. Members instinctively create conditions for honest dialogue, prayerful discernment, and courageous obedience in every context. Stage 5 culture is portable. A leader cannot help the group reach Stage 5 without having been there themselves.

3.3 Key Observations on the Taxonomy

Pharisee counter-example: The Pharisees scored perfectly on every Stage 2 behavior — attendance, tithing, prayer frequency, Scripture knowledge, public righteousness — yet Jesus declared tax collectors and prostitutes would enter the kingdom before them (Matt. 21:31). This is the fundamental danger of confusing behavioral compliance (Stage 2) with character transformation (Stage 5).

Humility marker: The closer one gets to Christ, the more aware one becomes of the gap. This mark of humility — the opposite of Pharisaical self-assurance — may be one of the major indicators of genuine progress.

The Holy Spirit's role at every transition: Each level shift requires the convicting work of the Spirit (John 14:8–11) and a cross-focused response. Formation is not simply progressive — it requires dying and rising.

Small group leadership constraint: A leader cannot help a group grow into Stage 5 if they have not been there themselves. Any new group will begin with a mix of people at different levels; the leader's own formation is the binding constraint.

Measurement challenge (and humility): The deeper levels are partially opaque to external observation by design. Measurement is possible (Hubbard, *How to Measure Anything*, 1–48) but requires clarity about what is being asked and appropriate humility about what instruments can and cannot detect.

4. A Trio of Taxonomies

Bloom's original cognitive taxonomy (1956; updated 2001, Anderson & Krathwohl) and the psychomotor taxonomy (Simpson, 1972) work alongside the Affective Taxonomy as three interdependent domains. Krathwohl emphasized (Affective Domain, 45–62) that cognitive and affective are inseparable: you cannot value what you do not understand, and understanding alone does not produce motivation to internalize.

Formation model: The three taxonomies operate as an integrated system.

- Cognitive domain (preaching, teaching, Scripture study): Builds the mental model of who God is, what He has said, what is of value. Provides content for the affective domain to internalize.
- Affective domain (internalization, motivation, heart transformation): The taxonomy proposed in this paper. Driven by the Spirit's convicting and renewing work. Describes why people pursue formation and how deeply they have internalized it.
- Psychomotor domain (practices, liturgy, embodied worship): Structures the body and habits for formation. James K.A. Smith (Desiring the Kingdom, 17–18): rightly structured liturgy at physical and cognitive levels invites a heart response in the affective domain — an action in the cognitive/psychomotor to invite affective internalization.

Affective measurement gap: The affective taxonomy has been the slowest adopted in educational practice (Potgieter et al., Nurse Education in Practice 86, 2025) precisely because of measurement difficulty — not because it is unimportant, but because it is hardest to observe. This paper claims the difficulty is worth the effort for church leaders serious about disciple formation.

5. Testing the Model: Preaching and Worship

5.1 Preaching (Cognitive Domain → Affective Invitation)

Preaching operates primarily in the cognitive domain: presenting correct doctrine about who God is and what Christ has done. Within the trio-taxonomy model, preaching creates the mental model of what is valuable and to be internalized — a cognitive invitation to see with spiritual eyes. Shields ("Preaching and Spiritual Formation," in Foundations, 254): transformation requires God's Word; "the one who preaches for transformation must study the Bible in such a way that there is a high degree of confidence that what the preacher says is also what God is saying." Importantly, Shields (250–251) applies this first to the preacher's own formation — the preacher must be transformed before delivering cognitive content. Lowe observation: most churches get the order wrong — starting with worship before the Word. Correct order: Word first, as training in hearing God's voice, then worship as the natural response.

5.2 Worship (Psychomotor/Cognitive → Affective Heart Response)

Worship is the whole-person response to internalizing truth about who God is: loving God with heart, soul, mind, and strength (Mark 12:30). Smith (Desiring the Kingdom, 17–18): liturgy is a psychomotor/cognitive structure that invites people to desire the Kingdom — an embodied invitation to affective-level formation. Averbeck ("Worship and Spiritual Formation," in Foundations, 62–63): "Worship is about the presence of God and our engaging with that

presence. Spiritual formation is about how to actually go about engaging with the presence of God, walking with him day by day... in worship, prayer, obedience, witness, spiritual disciplines." Taxonomy application: worship that remains at Stage 2 (attendance, following liturgy from obligation) is Pharisaical. Worship as formation operates at Stage 3 and above — moving from performing worship to entering worship from the heart.

5.3 Integration: Neither Alone Is Sufficient

Neither preaching nor worship alone produces Stage 5 formation. The Parable of the Sower makes clear that the heart's state determines what is received. The model's integrative claim: all spiritual disciplines can be examined as interactions with the three taxonomies, each supporting or hindering progressive internalization. The human role is to put ourselves in situations where we are willing to listen more deeply and obey more quickly — individually and corporately.

6. Integrating Challenges

6.1 Willard vs. Friesen: Quotidian Guidance

Willard (*Hearing God*, 276–280) proposes cultivating a continuous conversational relationship with God, including seemingly trivial daily decisions. Friesen (*Decision Making and the Will of God*, 82) critiques this as treating God mechanistically — mature believers should not need divine input on trivial matters. Taxonomy resolution: both critiques are correct at different levels. Willard's practice is training for movement from Stage 2 (doing it because an expert says to) to Stage 3 (doing it because I've found the payoff worth it). Friesen is critiquing Willard for not describing Stage 5 — but Willard is not claiming to describe Stage 5; he is describing a practice for earlier-stage formation. Brother Lawrence (*Practice of the Presence*) supports the same method: repetition until presence-awareness becomes automatic (Stage 5). The taxonomy turns the debate into an invitation to ongoing dialogue about which practices are most effective at each level.

6.2 Suffering as Formation Engine

Suffering is not an interruption of the formation journey — it is potentially its engine. Brueggemann (*Spirituality of the Psalms*, 8–12): the disorientation phase (lament psalms) always focuses on God, who can redeem even this. John of the Cross (*Dark Night*, Bk. 1, Ch. 6): the pilgrim must recognize the dark night and remain in it to receive what God has on the other side. Secular parallel: Tedeschi & Calhoun's posttraumatic growth (*Psychological Inquiry* 15:1, 2004) — positive change emerges from the struggle with highly challenging life crises, including increased appreciation for life, more meaningful relationships, richer spiritual life.

6.3 Non-Linear Progress: Spiral Rather Than Staircase

The original taxonomy implies linear step-by-step progression; real formation looks more like a spiral. A Stage 4 person suffering a tragic loss (e.g., death of a child) may appear to regress to Stages 1–2 — asking foundational questions about who God is and why they should even attend to his words. This should be understood as Brueggemann's disorientation: not regression but an invitation into a deeper relationship. The taxonomy needs extension to account for this: progress can be real even when it externally resembles reversal. This non-linearity is also why the affective domain is hard to measure — Potgieter et al. (2025) confirm this is the central challenge for adoption in educational practice. Hubbard's assurance (How to Measure Anything, 1–48): clarity about what is being asked makes measurement possible; the taxonomy provides that clarity.

7. Expansion Into Other Domains

7.1 Church-Wide Extensions

The individual and small-group taxonomy can extend to church-wide actions supporting formation. Preaching and liturgy can include church-wide teaching in practicing the presence, listening prayer, identifying God's voice, gifts identification and deployment. Both MOVE and NCD identify similar practices; their weakness is measurement (single-point self-report captures only Stage 1–2 behaviors). The Energy Trilogy represents Schwarz's attempt to address this weakness at its root — by grounding NCD's empirical findings in a theological account of how divine energy actually operates in the formation process, so that the framework can explain why certain practices correlate with outcomes, not merely document that they do. The taxonomy provides a framework for designing church programs at specific formation levels, not just delivering content.

7.2 Denominational and Cross-Cultural Extensions

Foster's six Streams of Living Water (Streams, 1998) represent recurring Holy Spirit revivals over 2,000 years of church history, each emphasizing different aspects of formation: Contemplative, Holiness, Charismatic, Social Justice, Evangelical, Incarnational. The Social Justice stream (liberation theology): adds recognition of how Jesus enters into suffering of the marginalized (Matt. 5:2–11). Orthodox/Catholic traditions: spiritual direction (Nemeck & Coombs, Way of Spiritual Direction, 83–84) is specifically about helping the pilgrim learn to hear from God for themselves — a direct application of Stage 3–5 formation. Asian Christian perspectives (Chan, Spiritual Theology; Nee, Normal Christian Life): the taxonomy's Western formulation would need cultural extension; cross-cultural dialogue about areas of agreement and disagreement could validate or correct the framework.

7.3 Possible Extensions and Open Questions

Stage 0 / Stage -1: Could there be a Stage 0 (hard heart, unwilling to engage) grounded in Prov 1:8 ("fear of the LORD is the beginning of wisdom")? A Stage -1 of active resistance (C.S. Lewis, *Screwtape Letters* as reference)?

Other disciplines: How does the Affective Taxonomy apply to growth in the Fruit of the Spirit (Gal. 5:22–23)? To the three eternal virtues of faith, hope, and love (1 Cor. 13:13)?

Universal-church application: Thompson (Paul, 247): the consciousness of the universal church "liberates the local community from narrow parochialism" — the taxonomy could serve as an integrating framework for what all those who call upon the Lord's name are doing together, across denominations and geographies.

8. Conclusion

Spiritual formation is growth in love of God and neighbor — the two great commandments — showing up in behavior from the heart, not performance. The central insight of this paper is that hearing and obeying God is not one discipline among many: it is foundational to all other disciplines, the meta-discipline Jesus identified in Mark 4:13. The Affective Taxonomy, mapped to the Parable of the Sower, provides a descriptive, biblically-grounded heuristic for the human side of the Spirit's formation work.

The taxonomy is not the agent of transformation — that work is irreducibly the Holy Spirit's in individuals and collectives, such that both are transformed in the process. But the taxonomy names what observable human progress looks like, enables leaders to design formation environments appropriate to each level, and integrates individual, small-group, and church-wide formation into a single coherent framework.

At its deepest level, Stage 5 describes what a person and a small group look like when love of God and neighbor has stopped being a commandment to be obeyed and has become simply who they are. The Spirit, working through Word, community, suffering, preaching, worship, and more, has formed it in them.

"Further up and further in." — C.S. Lewis, The Last Battle

Bibliography

Anderson, Lorin W., and David R. Krathwohl, eds. *A Taxonomy for Learning, Teaching, and Assessing: A Revision of Bloom's Taxonomy of Educational Objectives*. New York: Longman, 2001.

Andrews, Alan, and Christopher Morton. "Epilogue." In *The Kingdom Life: A Practical Theology of Discipleship and Spiritual Formation*, edited by Alan Andrews. Colorado Springs, CO: NavPress, 2010.

Asumang, Annang. "Review of Hawkins and Parkinson, *Move: What 1000 Churches REVEAL about Spiritual Growth*." *Conspectus* 14, no. 1, September 2012.

Averbeck, Richard E. "Spirit, Community, and Mission: A Biblical Theology for Spiritual Formation." *Journal of Spiritual Formation & Soul Care* 1, no. 1, 2008.

Averbeck, Richard E. "The Bible in Spiritual Formation." In *The Kingdom Life*, edited by Alan Andrews. Colorado Springs, CO: NavPress, 2010.

Averbeck, Richard E. "The Holy Spirit in the Hebrew Bible and Its Connections to the New Testament." In *Who's Afraid of the Holy Spirit?*, edited by Sawyer and Wallace. Richardson, TX: Biblical Studies Press, 2005.

Averbeck, Richard E. "Worship and Spiritual Formation." In *Foundations of Spiritual Formation*, edited by Paul Pettit. Grand Rapids, MI: Kregel Academic & Professional, 2008.

Bock, Darrell L. "New Testament Community and Spiritual Formation." In *Foundations of Spiritual Formation*, edited by Paul Pettit. Grand Rapids, MI: Kregel, 2008.

Bramer, Paul D. G. "Christian Formation: Tweaking the Paradigm." *Christian Education Journal*, Series 3, 4, no. 2, Fall 2007.

Brother Lawrence. *The Practice of the Presence of God*. Translated by Robert J. Edmonson. Edited by Hal M. Helms. Brewster, MA: Paraclete Press, 1985.

Brueggemann, Walter. *Spirituality of the Psalms*. Minneapolis, MN: Fortress Press, 2002.

Chan, Simon. *Spiritual Theology: A Systematic Study of the Christian Life*. Downers Grove, IL: InterVarsity Press, 1998.

Ellas, John, and Flavil R. Yeakley Jr. "Book Review: *Natural Church Development* by Christian Schwarz." *Journal of the American Society for Church Growth* 10, no. 2, 1999.

Firth, David C. "The Historical Books." In *A Biblical Theology of the Holy Spirit*, edited by Burke and Warrington. London: SPCK, 2014.

Foster, Richard J. *Celebration of Discipline: The Path to Spiritual Growth*. 3rd ed. San Francisco: HarperSanFrancisco, 1998.

Foster, Richard J. *Streams of Living Water: Celebrating the Great Traditions of Christian Faith*. San Francisco: HarperSanFrancisco, 1998.

Friesen, Garry, with J. Robin Maxson. *Decision Making and the Will of God*. Expanded ed. Colorado Springs: Multnomah, 2004.

Hawkins, Greg L., and Cally Parkinson. *Move: What 1,000 Churches Reveal about Spiritual Growth*. Grand Rapids, MI: Zondervan, 2011.

Hubbard, Douglas W. *How to Measure Anything: Finding the Value of Intangibles in Business*. 3rd ed. Hoboken, NJ: John Wiley & Sons, 2014.

Hubbard, Moyer. "2 Corinthians." In *A Biblical Theology of the Holy Spirit*, edited by Burke and Warrington. London: SPCK, 2014.

John of the Cross. "The Dark Night." In *The Collected Works of St. John of the Cross*, translated by Kavanaugh and Rodriguez. Washington, DC: ICS Publications, 1991.

Johnston, Gordon H. "Old Testament Community and Spiritual Formation." In *Foundations of Spiritual Formation*, edited by Paul Pettit. Grand Rapids, MI: Kregel, 2008.

Krathwohl, David R., Benjamin S. Bloom, and Bertram B. Masia. *Taxonomy of Educational Objectives: The Classification of Educational Goals, Handbook II: Affective Domain*. New York: David McKay, 1964.

Levi, Daniel, and David A. Askay. *Group Dynamics for Teams*. 6th ed. Thousand Oaks, CA: SAGE, 2021.

Lewis, C. S. *The Last Battle*. New York: HarperCollins, 1956.

Lewis, C. S. *The Screwtape Letters*. New York: HarperOne, 2001.

Lowe, Stephen D., and Mary E. Lowe. *Ecologies of Faith in a Digital Age: Spiritual Growth through Online Education*. Downers Grove, IL: IVP Academic, 2018.

Lowe, Stephen. Video lectures in DSMN 850, Liberty University, 2026 (Introduction; OT Theology; Pauline Theology; Worship & Preaching; Integrating Summary).

Morrow, Jonathan. "Introducing Spiritual Formation." In *Foundations of Spiritual Formation*, edited by Paul Pettit. Grand Rapids, MI: Kregel, 2008.

Nee, Watchman. *The Normal Christian Church Life*. 2nd ed. Anaheim, CA: Living Stream Ministry, 1980.

Nee, Watchman. *The Normal Christian Life*. Wheaton, IL: Tyndale House, 1977.

Nee, Watchman. *The Spiritual Man*. Anaheim, CA: Living Stream Ministry, 1998.

Nemeck, Francis Kelly, and Marie Theresa Coombs. *The Way of Spiritual Direction*. Wilmington, DE: Michael Glazier, 1985.

Potgieter, Lizelle et al. "Teaching, Learning and Assessment of the Affective Domain of Undergraduate Students: A Scoping Review." *Nurse Education in Practice* 86, 2025.

Powlison, David. "Cure of Souls (and the Modern Psychotherapies)." In *The Biblical Counseling Movement: History and Context*. Greensboro, NC: New Growth Press, 2010.

Schwarz, Christian A. *Natural Church Development: A Guide to Eight Essential Qualities of Healthy Churches*. 7th ed. Carol Stream, IL: ChurchSmart Resources, 2006. [Original: 1996]

Schwarz, Christian A. *The 3 Colors of Your Spirituality: 9 Spiritual Styles — How Do You Most Naturally Connect with God?* Carol Stream, IL: ChurchSmart Resources, 2009.

Schwarz, Christian A. *The 3 Colors of Community: How the 7 Communal Qualities of Healthy Small Groups Can Help You Overcome the 7 Deadly Sins*. Carol Stream, IL: ChurchSmart Resources, 2012.

Schwarz, Christian A. *God's Energy, Vol. 1: Reclaiming a New Testament Reality. The Energy Trilogy, Book 1*. NCD International/ChurchSmart Resources, 2021.

Schwarz, Christian A. *God's Energy, Vol. 2: Refocusing Our Image of God. The Energy Trilogy, Book 2*. NCD International/ChurchSmart Resources, 2021.

Schwarz, Christian A. *God's Energy, Vol. 3: Transforming Christianity. The Energy Trilogy, Book 3*. NCD International/ChurchSmart Resources, 2022. [FLAG for John: Verify publication year against your own copy.]

Shields, H. "Preaching and Spiritual Formation." In *Foundations of Spiritual Formation*, edited by Paul Pettit. Grand Rapids, MI: Kregel, 2008.

- Simpson, Elizabeth J. "The Classification of Educational Objectives in the Psychomotor Domain." *The Psychomotor Domain*, vol. 3. Washington, DC: Gryphon House, 1972.
- Smith, James K. A. *Desiring the Kingdom: Worship, Worldview, and Cultural Formation*. Grand Rapids: Baker Academic, 2009.
- Tedeschi, Richard G., and Lawrence G. Calhoun. "Posttraumatic Growth: Conceptual Foundations and Empirical Evidence." *Psychological Inquiry* 15, no. 1, 2004.
- Thompson, James W. *The Church according to Paul: Rediscovering the Community Conformed to Christ*. Grand Rapids, MI: Baker Academic, 2014.
- Warrington, Keith. "The Synoptic Gospels." In *A Biblical Theology of the Holy Spirit*, edited by Burke and Warrington. London: SPCK, 2014.
- Willard, Dallas. *Hearing God: Developing a Conversational Relationship with God*. Updated ed. Downers Grove, IL: IVP Books, 2012.
- Willard, Dallas, et al. *The Kingdom Life: A Practical Theology of Discipleship and Spiritual Formation*. Colorado Springs, CO: NavPress, 2010.